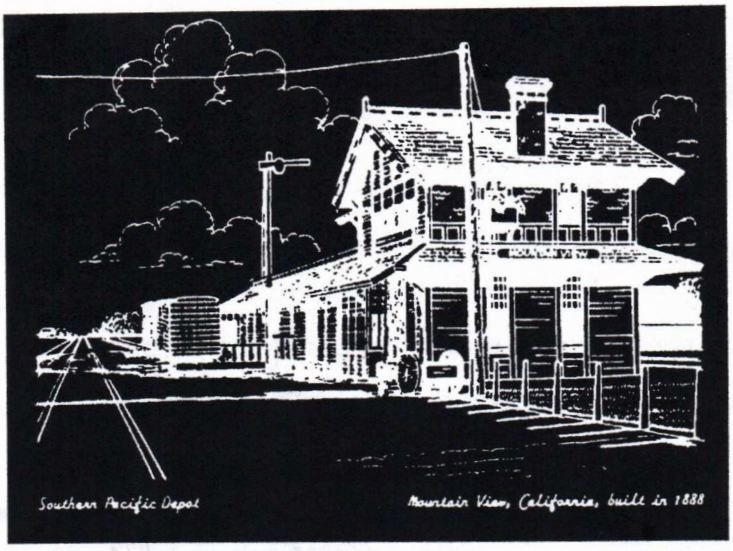
NOVEMBER 2006

Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
Trudi Tuban - Editor



DEER HOLLOW FARM
SUNDAY, NOVEMBER 5, 2006 @ 2 PM

A VCR titled "Life at Deer Hollow Farm," by Beverly McChesney, will be shown with an introduction and historical background by Barbara Kinchen, Mountain View's City Historian.

Deer Hollow Farm, now a Mountain View farm park, evolved from the Grant Family Ranch. The Perham Family then occupied the ranch from 1937 through 1974. The VCR has an interview of George Perham who was eight years old when he moved to the ranch. There is also an interview of Mountain View Park employee and docent, John Johnigan, during a tour of the property and Jasper's cabin with its period furnishings.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE BY NICK GALIOTTO

The Association's Annual Barbeque had a great turn-out and it looked like everyone enjoyed themselves. That was the second Barbeque of my two year term as President

and the November membership meeting brings my term to an end (how quickly the time goes by).

What is not ending is the Association's effort to prevail on the City for a Museum at the Cuesta Annex. Committee Chairman, Bob Weaver, is asking members to show support by attending the Council Study Session on October 24. I was at the Firefighters' fund raiser for their children's burn center recently and saw the old Model T fire truck that they're restoring. It is the first motor-driven fire vehicle that Mountain View had. Captain Cliff Del Carlo said displaying it in the proposed Museum would complement other artifacts and agricultural implements that reflect the actual history of Mountain View. Nearly all the cities in Santa Clara County have a museum, shouldn't we?

Our Executive Committee met on September 27. It was noted that the Nominating Committee is proposing candidates for election at the November meeting. They are: Bob Weaver for President, Vivian Schatz for Vice President, Margaret Peterson for Secretary, and Pat Figueroa for Treasurer.

Also, purchase was authorized for a quantity of the Mountain View and Moffett Field Pictorial history books that the Association can sell along with our own book.

Well, it's time to turn over the reins, so I'll close with my usual comment. Join us at our meeting and bring a friend. You'll enjoy learning about Mountain View's rich history and conversing with many of those who have lived it. See you on November 5th!

BBQ RAFFLE DONATORS

Book Buyers, 317 Castro Street, Mountain View 94041
Hobee's, 3312 Central Expressway, Mountain View 94043
Michael's at Shoreline, 2960 N. Shoreline Blvd., Mountain View 94043
Betty's Hair Designers, 2067 Grant Road, Los Altos, 94024
Mountain View Center for Performing Arts, 500 Castro Street, Mountain View 94040
Shoreline Golf Links, 2940 N. Shoreline Blvd., Mountain View 94043
El Camino YMCA, 2400 Grant Road, Mountain View, 94040
Sunnymont Produce, El Camino Real, Sunnyvale

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN

125 YEARS AGO (1881):
Mr. George Wells, new principal at the grammar school, was acquitted of the charge of battery on young Tommy Steeley.

100 YEARS AGO (1906):
Average attendance at the grammar school was 350, while that at the high school was 60.

The new "Opera House" is almost completed. Adjacent to the Farmers and Merchants Bank (now Red Rock Coffee House) on Castro Street, it has three stores on street level with a large upper auditorium and stage.

75 Years ago (1931):
Henry and Ernest Powell, in the grocery business on Castro Street since 1911, are retiring.

Minton Company, 599 Front Street (now Evelyn Avenue), sold the lumber mill and plumbing business to Builders Service Company. Mr. Earl Minton, former owner, will operate as a contractor from a Palo Alto office and will continue the development of Palmta Park subdivision at Loreto and Velarde Streets.

As recommended by the Chamber of Commerce Road Committee, Council approved a study for a road to run from the Castro Street-Railroad crossing directly to the new Naval Air Station. Only a short portion would be within the City limits. Moffett Boulevard had already been chosen as the name in honor of Rear Admiral William A. Moffett, Chief of The Bureau of Aeronautics, who had done so much for locating the Air Station in the Bay Area. (Later, the base also carried the Moffett name. The Admiral went down in the Atlantic with the dirigible AKRON in 1933.)

50 YEARS AGO (1956):
Local businesses are now giving the new Blue Chip stamps, one for each 10 cents purchase. These stamps can be redeemed for special merchandise. Mr. Blue Chip chipmunk says, "Be wise, economize with Blue Chip stamps."

Vice President Richard M. Nixon and wife, Pat, flew into Moffett Field in a charter plane, one stop in a 14 state campaign tour. They were met by a crowd of 300 and escorted to San Jose for speeches at FMC and San Jose State College.

Mountain View Feed and Fuel, 1058 Villa Street, advertised a one-week special -- one free parakeet with purchase of a cage.

November 1956 saw the grand opening of the New Palm Plaza Shopping Center, Castro Street between Mercy and Church Street (current Kaiser Health Foundation Clinic location). Anchored by Lucky Market, other merchants included Palm Variety, Rita Mari Fashions, Barber Shop, Basting's Sewing Center, Bert's Donut Bar, Careful Cleaners and Yorkshire Clothes.

25 YEARS AGO (1981):

Mountain View High School on Castro Street, closed in June, has been renamed as the Continuing Education Center. Buildings and facilities are now used by the City, YMCA, Mood Disorder Clinic, Headstart Program, Adult Education, Karate Studio and Foothill College.

Kathy and Karl Meier operate Mountain View's first and only bed and breakfast facility at 938 Villa Street, the former Julius Weilheimer home (now the Chez TJ Restaurant).

The Peninsula Lace Mavericks have a Lace Museum at the Old Mill Shopping Center on California Street.

San Francisco is negotiating to extend its contract to bring garbage to Mountain View, offering to pay $9 per ton, much higher than the $5.69 which neighboring cities will pay.

The 66-year old Dunshee house was moved from Ferguson Drive, near Central Expressway, to the corner of Calderon Avenue and Eldora Drive and will be extensively remodeled by two local school teachers (now again being remodeled).

Two Worlds is now open at El Camino Real and Calderon Avenue. Shops and professional offices are at street level facing El Camino with housing above and on the rest of the former Highway Grammar School property.

STREET TALK BY BARBARA KINCHEN

Several members contacted us with information about Showers Drive, so we know you are reading the newsletter. Nick Perry's new picture book on Mountain View, page 19, has photos taken of Showers Lane/Showers Drive in 1960 and 1961, with some facts about James Showers who owned property where the street is. He served as street superintendent, grammar school trustee from 1895 until 1898 and died in 1910. Showers Drive bordered the eastern side of the beginning-to-be developed San Antonio Shopping Center. BAZA'R occupied the large commercial building on the eastern side of the new street. (Target is located there now.)

Hereafter, there will only be a street question when we truly do not know the answer.

STREET QUESTION

A gentlemen living on Marich Way wants to know the origin of that name. Can you help supply that information?

NEW TO THE MOUNTAIN VIEW LIBRARY'S HISTORY CENTER

Sent to us by San Mateo's Chapter of the Japanese Citizens League, the new book "Building a Community -- The Story of Japanese Americans in San Mateo County."

From member Ben DeBolt: Nine DVDs, copies of KMVT's "City View" shows with Ben as host. Included are "Dirigible Days at Moffett Field," "50th Jubilee of Moffett Field" and "Saving the Adobe Building."

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE REPORT

The Mountain View Historical Association Executive Committee met on September 27, 2006. Discussions were held concerning sales of the new Mountain View and the Moffett Field books; new items received by the Library History Center; the Cuesta Annex museum and heritage orchard and a donation to the library of the new Mountain View and Moffett Field books.

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND EXECUTIVE OFFICERS

President	Nick Galiotto
Vice President	Vivian Schatz
Sergeant at Arms	JohnViscovich
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer	Pat Figueroa
Past President	Craig Holden
Editor	Trudi Tuban
Membership	June Casey
Memorials & Remembrances	Edna Thompson
Programs & Publicity	Wally Erichsen
Hospitality	Dorothy Rich
Ways & Means	Hip Telmont
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Al Jehning

MEMBERSHIP REPORT BY JUNE CASEY

Single Members	107
Family Members	132
Life Members	121
Honored Members	2
TOTAL	= 362

New A/S Members: David B. Flynn, Betty Brooks Wagner
New Family Members: John M. Inks, Arleen & Allan Fink

Barbara Kinchen has become an "honored member" as a thank you for all she has done for the MVHA and the City of Mountain View.

INCOME AND EXPENSE STATEMENT

Ending Balance as of June 28, 2006: $37,531.93 *
Income: $2,283.67
Expenses: $1,984.48
Balance as of September 26, 2006: $37,831.12

* Note that the June Income and Expense Statement incorrectly listed the ending balance as $37,424.93. It should have been $37,531.93. The income and expense balances are correct. The difference between the numbers is a deposit correction of $107.00 on 6/23/2006.

IN MEMORIAM

HARRY PINTO passed away August 26. He predeceased his wife IDA (noted below) by only 12 hours. Predeceased by son, Mark in 1977, and survived by daughters, Cheryl Sullivan and Denise Pinto. He was predeceased by his sister, Doris Seibert, and his brother, Neal Pinto. Harry was raised in Mountain View and graduated from Mountain View High School in 1932. As a Marine during WWII, Harry became a prisoner of war at Cabanatuan in the Philippines. He also served in Korea during the "Peace Action." He later worked as a tax assessor for Santa Clara County and was the proprietor of Hallmark Stationary on Castro Street. Member of Mason Lodge 194, A&FM, SIRS Branch 35, Life member of Defenders of Batan & Corregidor, DAV and the Mountain View Historical Association.

IDA PINTO was born in Vacaville and was a star basketball player at the Vacaville High School. She later moved to Mountain View and worked as an assistant city clerk and head bookkeeper for her family's grocery store chain, Escano. Ida and Harry were married for 67 years. She was a volunteer with the Christmas Food Bank and El Camino Hospital and was past president of Quadalco Club.

WARREN "SWEDE" NELSON passed away in Colorado Springs, Colorado on July 31. He is survived by his wife of 59 years, Betty Castle; three daughters, Susan Larson, Linda Ribary, Peggy Bryd and son Craig Nelson. Swede was an Aeronautical Research Scientist at the NASA Ames Research Center, Moffett Field. He was involved in many organizations including the Mountain View Historical Association.

Historical Museum Update

Your museum committee has been working diligently to keep the Historical Museum proposal on track, during the public hearing process. When the city began its public discussion regarding the future of Cuesta Annex, the association had concerns that our proposal would be lost in the smoke of battle between the open space group and the playing field group. We were assured that the process would be based on the merit of ideas presented, and not on the volume or intensity of the rhetoric. Quality over quantity would be the order of the day.

However well intended, that goal has not as yet been realized, and we felt compelled to assemble a document and re-present our proposal to the city council as it was in the beginning.

The document includes a rendering by local artist Robert Schick, of the Annex as it would appear with the museum, barn and orchard in place, a point-by-point synopsis of our proposal, beautiful letters from some of our members expressing in their own words the desire for a museum, an editorial from the Mountain View Voice favorable to the establishment of a museum at the Annex and an article from the Town Crier on environmentally sensitive "green building" techniques.

Your committee has done their homework and created a very well thought out museum proposal, but ideas alone, regardless of how good they may be, will not carry the day on their own. There are other groups with their visions for the annex, and they don't include a museum. They attend the meetings in great numbers and have dominated the discussions there. **We have less than a month before the City Council will set the plan for the Annex, and your help is needed for the museum plan to prevail.**

There will be a City Council study session for the Annex on Tuesday, October 24, at 5:00 P.M. in the Council chambers. This will present our best opportunity to influence the Council. The decisions made at this meeting will form the final Annex usage proposals to be voted on in November. Please support the museum plan and your committee by attending this study session at 5:00 P.M. October 24, in Council chambers. **You do not need to speak.** Your attendance at this vital meeting is all we ask.

I look forward to seeing you then,

Robert H. Weaver
Museum Committee Chair

Mountain View

Historical

Association

REGULAR MEETING

VCR of "LIFE AT

DEER HOLLOW FARM"

With Introduction & History

By Barbara Kinchen

Sunday, 11/5/2006 @ 2pm

The Adobe Building

Moffett Blvd and

Central Expressway

Membership: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

Aims: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME:

ADDRESS:

TELEPHONE:

TYPE: NEW_____ RENEWAL_____

Regular Member $10/year
Family Membership $15/year
Life Member $200.00

Make Check Payable to:

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P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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